NO. 145 · SINGAPORE

THE CURRENT BRIEFING OF

MERIDIAN

Twelve desks. One world.

TUESDAY 27 OCTOBER 2026



A COMPLETE COUNT, AND A RESULT THAT IS NOT SETTLED (P3)

TECHNOLOGY

A filing gives revenue to the dollar and its compute bill as a dollar sign, blank

THE ATELIER

The baking sheet that wins every test is the same gauge as the cheapest pan in the trade

THE LONG READ

Nepal is electrifying its kitchens through the worse appliance, because the pots are round

Source: Natacha Pisarenko / Associated Press, via Al Jazeera. Lula and Geraldo Alckmin at the victory rally, São Paulo, 25 October 2026.

THIS ISSUE · NO. 145

Contents

p3 The World — Lula wins, and the loser contests two hours
p4 The World — Israel votes with the crossings sealed
p5 Singapore — eight per cent, or two, of what
p6 The Atelier — the pan that wins is the thin one
p7 Technology — a dollar sign with nothing after it
p8 The Home Lab — nine downloads to one, and a cache bug
p9 The Kit — the second engine only the 512GB gets
p10 The Good Life — one watch, three prices
p11 Screen & Sound — seventy-six per cent, and fifty-nine
p12–13 The Family Desk — the alarm belongs to toddlers
p14 The Macro Desk — five per cent, and all of it real
p15–17 The Rabbit Hole — barbecue, and the orphaned pit
p18 Fitness — the null with nothing to declare
p19–20 The Diary — three closing dates, four new rooms
p21–23 The Long Read — Nepal electrifies through the wrong appliance

THE SPINE: COUNTED, NOT SETTLED. Eleven desks found the same shape: a figure published as if it closed the question, while the thing it measures is still open — and almost always the publisher chose the moment. Brazil's count is complete and its result is not. Serbia's commission congratulated the winners with **eighty-five of ninety-three** overseas stations uncounted. Israel votes after this page is set. The committee that will move or hold rates meets tomorrow, and a monitor prints 88.5 per cent as though that were a fact. On p7 a company states its revenue to the dollar and its compute obligation as a dollar sign with the number left out.

FROM THE DESK

"I beseech you, in the bowels of Christ, think it possible you may be mistaken."

Oliver Cromwell, letter to the General Assembly of the Church of Scotland, 3 August 1650[1]

Written three weeks before Dunbar, to men entirely certain of a count of their own. It is the one sentence this issue keeps earning: on p8 a "100 per cent recovery" turns out to be three benchmarks run once.

THE STRIP · AT MONDAY'S CLOSE

US 10-year[2]	5.00%	flat
10-yr breakeven[2]	2.34%	flat
VWRA	$190.10	▲ 0.26%
AGGU	$5.798	▲ 0.14%
Brent	$115.81	▼ 0.78%
Gold (Dec)	$4,031.00	▼ 3.10% wk
Bitcoin	$79,815	▼ 0.72%
USD/SGD	1.2793	▲ 0.20%
STI	5,415.91	▼ 0.12%

The whole five per cent is real yield: 5.00 minus 2.34 is 2.66. The subtraction is this magazine's own, of two curves the Treasury publishes separately (p14). Not advice.[2]

SIX NUMBERS FROM THIS ISSUE

A dollar sign, and nothing after it. A filing that gives revenue to the dollar states its total compute obligation as "more than $" with the figure left out (p7).

Eight of ninety-three. The overseas polling places counted when Serbia's commission president congratulated the winners from the chair (p4).

Twenty gauge. The metal in the half-sheet pan that wins every home test — the same thickness as the cheapest pan in the trade catalogue (p6).

Seventy-six, and fifty-nine. One film, two aggregate scores, from the same kind of notices: eighteen mixed reviews counted as thumbs up by one and as fifties by the other (p11).

Two point four against one point one six. The screen-and-attention odds for preschoolers against children over six, averaged into a single 1.56 (p12).

Three thousand megawatts. What a Nepali state agency says full electric cooking would add, against a national peak demand of 2,320 (p22).

SOURCES 1 Cromwell to the General Assembly of the Church of Scotland, 3 August 1650, as the letter is printed in the standard collections of his letters and speeches. 2 Levels at Monday's close, each read at its own source and sourced individually on p14, where the real yield is derived from the two Treasury curves.

THE WORLD · BRAZIL'S RUN-OFF

Lula wins Brazil's run-off; Flávio Bolsonaro refuses to concede

The electoral court's count gives Lula 51.79 per cent against 48.21 — 4,430,191 votes — and the loser will petition to annul a two-hour polling extension that his own campaign had also asked for.

Brazil's Superior Electoral Court declared **Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva** the winner of Sunday's presidential run-off with **64,256,232** votes against Senator **Flávio Bolsonaro**'s **59,826,041**, all sections counted. It is Lula's fourth non-consecutive term, and the first time since Brazil adopted two rounds in 1989 that a candidate has overturned a first-round deficit — Bolsonaro led 47 to 45 on 4 October.[1]

Turnout was **80.78 per cent**, up 1.57 points, on three million fewer abstentions. The count crossed sides: Lula at 51.16 on five per cent counted, Bolsonaro at 50.41 on twenty, Lula at 50.14 on half.[1]

The contested fact is two hours. Supreme Court Justice **Cristiano Zanin** extended voting from 17:00 to 19:00 Brasília time after emergency petitions over blockades and weather. Bolsonaro calls it **"a dirty trick"** and notes Zanin was once Lula's personal defence lawyer. His own campaign had petitioned for an extension in **seventeen municipalities**, over rain in the south.[2]

So a complete count sits beside an unsettled result — and this page cannot read the court's own totals: its results portal returns nothing but the word *Resultados* to a non-browser. **The figures above are the court's, read everywhere except at the court.**[3]

> ***"The margin was quite significant, so I think it'll be really hard to convince voters that this is the result of vote rigging."***

BRASÍLIA — ANADOLU

Takes the challenge at face value and puts Zanin's old brief at its centre: Flávio Bolsonaro will "engage our legal team and seek to have these elections annulled".[2]

DOHA — AL JAZEERA

Frames the result as a regional turn — Lula's recovery "halted a string of right-wing gains in Latin America" — and gathers the congratulations, Beijing's among them: **Guo Jiakun** said China was "willing to work with Brazil". The ministry's own transcript was not reached.[4]

THE CHATTER · HACKER NEWS ARGUED TERM LIMITS

The thread ran to **490 points and 593 comments** and never mentioned the extension once. It argued about a fourth term instead. **SoftTalker**: "Presidency, like other elected positions, should not be a career." **stickfigure**: "The skill to win elections and the skill to govern are not the same." **spwa4** thought Meta's handling of Lula's accounts "probably mattered a lot more".[5]

THE SCEPTIC · BOTH CAMPS CLAIM THE SPACE WAS RIGGED

The annulment has one hook and one hole. The hook is Zanin. The hole is that Bolsonaro asked for the same extension. Meanwhile **Lula's party has itself filed against Meta**, after employees were reported as saying his accounts were throttled during the campaign — so both sides enter certification alleging a rigged information space. **The test is narrow and dated:** whether the court takes the petition, and whether *diplomação* is suspended. Neither had happened by Monday night. The market did not wait for either: **the B3 exchange in São Paulo halted trading for thirty minutes** on Monday as the index fell. No percentage appears on this page because the only figures in circulation come from a page citing no source for any of them.[6]

Two hours

THE POLLING EXTENSION BOTH CAMPAIGNS REQUESTED AND ONLY ONE NOW CALLS ILLEGITIMATE — 17:00 TO 19:00, BRASÍLIA[2]

SOURCES 1 Totals and turnout as the Superior Electoral Court reports them, carried by France 24's live page and the election record; the 51.79/48.21 split corroborated across two outlets, with Anadolu's earlier partial at 51.76/48.24. 2 France 24 and Anadolu (Laura Gamba, 26 October), both read in full; the seventeen-municipality petition is France 24's. 3 resultados.tse.jus.br renders only its own title to a static fetch; tse.jus.br/comunicacao/noticias returns **403**. 4 Al Jazeera's reaction round-up, read in full; **fmprc.gov.cn redirected and was not pursued, so Guo Jiakun is read at Al Jazeera, not at the ministry.** 5 Hacker News item 50237485. **Reddit refused this desk for the twelfth issue running.** 6 The Meta complaint via reporting of 16 October; the trading halt from Buenos Aires Times carrying Agence France-Presse, 26 October — **no percentage is printed because none could be sourced**. The falsification test is this desk's.

HEBRON · THE FIFTH DAY

Israel votes with every West Bank land crossing sealed

Lieutenant General Eyal Zamir told Netanyahu on Sunday that the Hebron operation has no operational reason and no legal basis; the Prime Minister ordered it to continue, and about 3,000 Palestinians are now displaced.

The Israeli army closed **all West Bank land crossings for the whole of Tuesday's election day**, and barred Palestinian workers from entering or leaving Judea, Samaria and the Jordan Valley — this time including the industrial zones exempted on Sunday and Monday. It is the fifth day of a lockdown on **Hebron**, imposed after two gunmen from the city, both 27, killed two soldiers at the Yehuda junction on Friday morning.[1]

On Sunday, at a situational assessment at Tel Nof air base, Chief of Staff **Lt. Gen. Eyal Zamir** told the Prime Minister there was **no operational reason** to continue the raid and **no legal basis** for keeping Palestinians from their homes. Netanyahu rejected the recommendation and ordered the operation to run through the vote. Kan, the public broadcaster, had it from a military source and from soldiers on the ground.[2]

The soldiers supplied the measure of it. Troops have scanned **about 500 structures and seized two guns**; some have not been home for **28 days**. One: "We're just sitting at these locations doing nothing." Hebron's municipality puts **35 hectares** demolished or marked for it.[2]

Two counts cannot both be right. The army says **"no civilians were forced to evacuate"**; Wafa counts **200 families** displaced and some **2,500 people** removed from al-Jilda and Ain Deir Baha. No Israeli High Court ruling on the demolitions exists in any source this desk could read — not pending; absent. Palestinian employment in Israel and the settlements has fallen from almost **200,000** before October 2023 to **44,000**.[3]

NEW YORK — UNITED NATIONS

Spokesman **Stéphane Dujarric**: the closures "severely restrict Palestinians' freedom of movement, access to basic services and livelihoods". The human-rights office's **Mayy El Sheikh** called the lockdown "yet another episode in a never-ending stream of suffocating measures".[4]

THE SCEPTIC · THIS PAGE HAS NO RESULT

Polls close at 22:00 Israel time, which is **four in the morning on Wednesday in Singapore** — after this edition is set. There is no turnout figure, no exit poll, and no word on whether the closure lifted. Anything printed about 27 October in Hebron or at the ballot box today would be invention, so nothing is. Some **60,000** non-resident Israelis flew home to vote.[5]

SERBIA · THE COUNT THAT CONGRATULATED ITSELF

The Republic Electoral Commission published a preliminary count at 21:42 on Monday, and its president **Vladimir Dimitrijević** congratulated the winners from the chair: "in my name and in the commission's name, since I still represent the commission". **Studentska lista: 2,267,615 votes, 52.71 per cent, 140 of 250 seats** — above the 126 needed. Vučić's United Serbia: 39.17 per cent, 104 seats. Dačić's Socialists took 2.17 per cent and **no seats at all**. Turnout 68.83 per cent, ten points above 2023.[6]

It is not certified, and the diaspora is not in it. Material from **eight of ninety-three** overseas polling places had arrived; the rest are ballots still travelling. The commission's own portal renders every field as zero, so these figures — like Brasília's on p3 — are the authority's, read elsewhere.[6]

IN BRIEF

Geneva, 26 Oct. The Human Rights Council's commission of inquiry found Israel "continuing to commit genocidal acts" in Gaza: West Bank deaths from airstrikes rose from **six** in the fifteen years to October 2023 to **254** since. Israel's mission demanded its dissolution.[7]

Jerusalem, 26 Oct. Defence Minister **Israel Katz** denied reports that Netanyahu plans to dismiss Zamir if re-elected; Yisrael Beytenu alleged interference by WhatsApp on the eve of the vote.[7]

SOURCES 1 Euronews (Nathan Rennolds, 25 October) and Al Jazeera the same day, both read in full; the attack details from the standing record of the lockdown. 2 The Times of Israel's live entry of 16:18 on 26 October, reporting Kan — read at source; the quoted soldiers are Kan's. 3 The army's denial via Euronews; Wafa's counts via the same; the employment figures are the International Labour Organization's. **Four independent reads turned up no High Court material of any kind.** 4 UN News, 23 October. 5 Closing time from the ballot's own schedule; the 60,000 figure is a front-page line, **and the article behind it was not opened**. 6 The commission's session as reported from the room by Dnevnik of Novi Sad, 21:42, updated 22:08; rik.parlament.gov.rs/542645/rezultati is reachable and **returns zeros**. 7 All four read at source on 26 October; the Jordan and WhatsApp items are live-blog entries timed 21:26 and 22:03.

SINGAPORE · THE GAS ROW

Jakarta puts the gas cut at eight per cent, Singapore at two

Bahlil Lahadalia told reporters on Monday not to lecture Indonesia about honouring contracts — and Singapore's own two statements, four days apart, measure the same "less than two per cent" against two different denominators.

Indonesia's energy minister **Bahlil Lahadalia** told a press briefing in Jakarta on Monday that the pipeline gas cut to Singapore sits inside the contract, and said: **"We respect the rules and contracts. Don't lecture Indonesia about honoring contracts."** Asked whether the cut was permanent, he said the situation "remains fluid", and then opened a door: "We respect contracts. But force majeure circumstances can arise, can't they? Well, we'll see."[1]

His arithmetic is a set of fractions. The cut is **31 BBTUD**; the export baseline **409.55**; so **"around 8 per cent"**, and **"if we lower it by 10 per cent, that would mean a contract violation"** — while the contract cap he names is **91 to 92 BBTUD**. Those three numbers do not reconcile with each other, and no source this desk read attempts it. Quote the minister; do not endorse the sum.[1]

Singapore's figure is **17 BBTUD over eighteen days**, and here is the part nobody has asked about. The Energy Market Authority said on Saturday that this was "less than 2 per cent of our **total daily gas demand of more than 1,000 bbtud**". The energy ministry said on Sunday it was "less than 2 per cent of our **power sector** gas demand per day". Power-sector demand is a subset of total demand, so the same volume cannot be under two per cent of both unless the two are nearly the same number.[2]

On the same Monday, Singapore answered with storage rather than argument. At Singapore International Energy Week the energy ministry and Saudi Arabia's declared a joint intent to hold Saudi crude here: caverns **150 metres underground**, up to **1.47 million cubic metres**, about nine million barrels, from the second half of **2027**. Minister **Tan See Leng** named **five new power plants** to 2031, lifting capacity **26 per cent** from about 12 gigawatts, and an IAEA nuclear review. His advice: **"keep calm and carry on"**.[3]

THE CHATTER · THE FORUM IS NOT WORRIED ABOUT THE BILL

A HardwareZone thread opened Sunday evening ran to **104 replies** on sovereign risk, not electricity. **BBClone**, most endorsed at thirteen reactions: "Plenty of land and resources, but the people governing simply lack any kind of trustworthiness." **Jeremy1**: "They can just changed the contract if they are not happy." A thread opened at **2.32 on Tuesday morning** concerned an Indonesian nuclear plant proposed for Kepri, in sight of Singapore.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · A TANK FARM IS NOT A RESERVE

In Aramco's comparable arrangements in **Japan and South Korea**, the host government has priority to buy the stored crude in a shortage. **The Singapore release states no such right** — no volumes, no terms, no offtake, no quotes. A supplier's tank is not a strategic reserve until someone says Singapore may draw on it. And the scale check nobody is making: the disrupted commodity is **pipeline gas**, about 95 per cent of the electricity. Nine million barrels of crude does not substitute for it.[5]

31 against 17

JAKARTA'S ANNOUNCED CUT AGAINST WHAT SINGAPORE'S REGULATOR COUNTS — UNRECONCILED FOR A FOURTH DAY, AND NOW IN THREE DIFFERENT UNITS[2]

ALSO THIS WEEK

Retirement at 65 from 1 January 2029, a year early. The Tripartite Workgroup on Senior Employment, after consulting over **1,000 stakeholders** since July 2025, recommended lifting the retirement age from 64 to 65 and re-employment from 69 to 70, ahead of the 2030 schedule. **The Government accepted every recommendation.** Details in the first half of 2027.[6]

The ministry has a new name. mti.gov.sg now redirects: since 1 October it is the **Ministry of Energy, Trade and Industry**. Its nuclear-manpower schemes launched Monday alongside the IAEA review.[3]

SOURCES 1 Jakarta Globe's report of Monday's briefing and Mothership citing The Straits Times, both read in full; every quoted line is the minister's. **His job title is rendered four different ways across four outlets.** 2 The authority's Saturday statement read via AsiaOne, which quotes it directly — **ema.gov.sg returns an empty body to anything but a browser**; the ministry's Sunday doorstop read at meti.gov.sg. One outlet renders the same volumes in a different unit entirely. 3 meti.gov.sg's Saudi release, read in full — **its substance is in a PDF not opened here**. 4 The thread read on the board index; **the forum's search returns 403**. 5 The Japan and Korea comparison is Reuters'; the rest is this desk's, from reading the release. 6 mom.gov.sg, 26 October. 7 A live blog; **pap.org.sg returns 403**.

THE ATELIER · BAKING TINS AND SHEET PANS

Nordic Ware's test-winning half sheet is 20 gauge, like Winco's cheapest

Vollrath and Lloyd Pans sell professionals the same pan at 18 gauge — 0.040 inch of aluminium — and the Minneapolis pan that wins every home test survives instead on an encapsulated galvanised rim.

Everything here turns on one number the trade publishes and the home catalogue does not. **Gauge** is an inverse scale: lower is thicker. **Lloyd Pans** of Spokane prints the conversion — **14 gauge is 0.063in, 16 is 0.050, 18 is 0.040** — and then the gauge of every pan it sells. Its half sheet is 18, its quarter sheet 14, which is why the smaller pan costs twice as much.[1]

Warping is buckling, driven by a temperature difference across the sheet. Stiffness rises steeply with thickness while the gradient is set by the oven, so each step of gauge buys far more resistance than mass. **Vollrath's Wear-Ever 5303 is 18 gauge**, and so is Lloyd's. **Nordic Ware's Naturals half sheet is 20** — a figure from its own support answer, not its packaging — and so is **Winco's US$5.73** economy pan.[2]

The Nordic Ware still wins, and it wins honestly: the rim does the work. Its claim is "encapsulated galvanised steel rims help prevent warping", and Vollrath specifies a "galvanized nonrusting rod" inside a closed bead for the same reason. **A raw cut edge or a plain curl is a cheap pan telling on itself.** Vollrath goes further and presses its pans slightly dished, so heat flattens them rather than popping them.[2]

Metal, by how fast it moves heat: aluminium **236 W/m·K**, tin 68, carbon steel 54, stainless **14.4** — sixteen times slower. **Anodising** grows an oxide out of the metal rather than laying a coating on it, so it cannot chip.[3]

On coatings one maker is candid. Lloyd grades its finishes by permanence: silicone glaze is good for "several hundred baking cycles", after which, its page says, **"LloydPans does not offer reglazing"**. Bundy, which owns USA Pan, runs a continent-wide business called **Pan Glo** reglazing commercial pans: the trade buys the pan as a frame and the surface as a consumable.[4]

The makers worth knowing. **USA Pan is Bundy** — the brothers' industrial pan business, pressing in Crescent, Pennsylvania since 1959; the 1lb seamless loaf **US$14.99**, the 13-inch Pullman **US$41.99**. **Silverwood** of Birmingham hand-finishes anodised aluminium: a 2lb round-cornered loaf tin **£27.30**. **Gobel**, France, 1887, still folds tinplate rather than soldering it.[5]

THE CHATTER · THE GRAIL IS A FIFTEEN-DOLLAR PAN

On The Fresh Loaf's Pullman thread, **trailrunner**: "The USA pans are the best… taking good care of it will give you a lifetime of enjoyment." **Sugarowl** dissents: "If you don't want to shell out the $35 for a pullman pan, then why not a regular loaf pan?" The care consensus is emphatic: **never aerosol release** — butter, or oil on a paper towel.[6]

THE SCEPTIC · THREE LIFETIMES, THREE MEANINGS

Read the guarantee, not the adjective. Silverwood says its tins are "designed and made to last a lifetime"; the guarantee, on another page, is **25 years**. USA Pan says "Lifetime Limited", then excludes "normal wear… such as scratches, dents, discoloration, and staining" — which is the surface you bake on. And **"Chicago Metallic" is two unrelated things**: the commercial one is Bundy's; the department-store one is a Lifetime Brands label, with materials sourced from China. The plant, metal and gauge need not follow the logo.[7]

NEXT ON THE BENCH

Mosquito nets — mesh counts, denier, and the treated nets the WHO lists.

Table linen — flax, damask weave, and why hotel linen outlasts yours.

Chef's whites — twill weight, the double breast, and who still sews them.

SOURCES 1 lloydpans.com/custom/capabilities and its pan pages, read 27 October; the gauge table is the maker's own. 2 vollrathfoodservice.com model 5303 (Gauge field 18); **Nordic Ware's 20-gauge figure is its customer-support answer on a retailer's listing, not on its own site.** 3 A published metals table; the anodising account is Lloyd's process plus America's Test Kitchen on acid reactivity. 4 lloydpans.com/custom/finishes, quoted verbatim; Pan Glo from Bundy's trade spec sheet. 5 usapan.com and silverwood-bakeware.com; **gobel.fr now redirects into another group and that site returned 403, so the ownership rests on the redirect alone.** 6 thefreshloaf.com node 71561. **Reddit refused this desk for the twelfth issue running, and Serious Eats refused it too.** 7 Each maker's own guarantee page; Lifetime Brands' own brand page. 8 shop.redmanshop.com, 27 October.

TECHNOLOGY · THE ANTHROPIC FILING

Anthropic files to list on Nasdaq and leaves its compute commitment blank

The S-1 gives first-half revenue as US$16.3bn and a first operating profit of US$1.0bn in the June quarter — then prints "aggregate committed spend of more than" a dollar sign with no figure after it.

Anthropic, PBC filed a Form S-1 with the Securities and Exchange Commission on Monday, seeking to list Class A stock on Nasdaq under the ticker **ANT**. The revenue line is the one everyone will quote: **US$41m in 2023, US$386m in 2024, US$4.6bn in 2025**, and **US$16.3bn** in the first half of 2026. The June quarter alone did **US$11.6bn** against US$787m a year earlier, and turned an operating loss of US$1.2bn into an operating profit of **US$1.0bn**.[1]

The sentence that matters is the one with nothing in it. Where the filing states the company's total obligation it reads **"aggregate committed spend of more than $, substantially all of which is related to compute and infrastructure"**, and then **"approximately $ expected to be incurred before December 31, ___"**. The number arrives in an amendment. Valuation, offering size and price range are blank too; the US$1bn on the fee table is a statutory placeholder.[2]

One compute figure is hard. A note purchase agreement with **Broadcom**, struck in March, allows up to **US$42.0bn** of convertible promissory notes to fund what the filing calls the 2026 Lease Arrangement, "to procure specialized AI accelerators and associated components". The company warns in its own risk language of agreements carrying "minimum purchase commitments, **take-or-pay provisions**... that obligate us to pay for resources regardless of actual utilization". Capital raised to June: **US$141.1bn**; cash **US$112.4bn**. Twenty-two underwriters.[2]

Washington spent the same Monday deleting a number. Treasury's outbound-investment proposal, published in the Federal Register as RIN 1505-AC94, removes the **10^{25} operations** threshold that defined a prohibited AI system and the 10^{23} one that made a deal notifiable. In their place sits a **"super intelligence (SI) system"** — defined, word for word, as the 2019 definition of *artificial intelligence* with the letters swapped. The supercomputer test, 100 double-precision petaflops in 41,600 cubic feet, survives untouched. Comments close 7 December.[3]

Beijing moved the opposite way on the same technology. Its commerce and science ministries' notice No. 48 restricts export of large-model **weights, checkpoints, source code and architecture** where any one of three limbs bites: compute at or above **10^{26} FLOP**, parameters at or above **two trillion**, or a model **ranked in the global top ten** on public evaluations — *at the moment the export occurs*. The chip-design limb triggers on, among others, "has floating-point or integer arithmetic capability".[4]

THE CHATTER · THE LAWYERS, NOT THE FORUMS

The reaction to Treasury's draft is institutional. **Ryan Majerus**, formerly of the US trade office: "It's just the first step in a fairly long process." **Jason Chipman** of WilmerHale says it "will require more substantial compliance programs to manage risk". **Craig Singleton** reads it as a signal that "Washington is tracking where U.S. capital is flowing". Beijing's **Mao Ning**: "Overstretching the concept of national security..."[5]

THE SCEPTIC · TREASURY ARGUED AGAINST ITSELF

In the alternatives section of the very same document, Treasury **rejects** defining prohibited technology as "all super intelligence" because it "would create ambiguity for U.S. persons". It then proposes a definition covering any machine-based system that makes "a classification, prediction, recommendation, or decision". **A linear regression in a spreadsheet satisfies that text.** The deleted 10^{25} figure was the only line in the old rule; the 100-petaflop number survived, which shows the drafters kept a number exactly where they wanted one.[3]

1,368% against 300%

REVENUE GROWTH AGAINST COMPUTE-AND-INFRASTRUCTURE EXPENSE GROWTH, JUNE QUARTER YEAR ON YEAR, IN THE FILING'S OWN WORDS[1]

SOURCES 1 Form S-1, Anthropic PBC, file 333-299633, filed 26 October — the main document read in full on EDGAR. All quoted language is the filing's. 2 Same document; the blanks are reproduced as they appear. The fee exhibit's US$1bn is a statutory placeholder, **not a deal size**. 3 Federal Register vol. 91 no. 205, full text read, compared line by line against the eCFR text of the rule it replaces. **regulations.gov returns 403 and is rate-limited, so the docket is unread, not empty.** 4 Notice No. 48 of 2026. **Attachment 1 is a proprietary binary behind a 403; this desk retrieved and converted it, and the superscript is lost in every conversion path.** 5 Associated Press reporting of 23 October. 6 The 8-K exhibit on EDGAR.

THE HOME LAB · QUANTISATION

ISTA-DASLab's quantisation out-downloads DeepSeek's own release nine to one

891,147 against 95,889 in nine days; the repository has at last published its sizes, 231 to 266 gigabytes — and the llama.cpp support merged this week corrupts output whenever a prompt prefix is reused.

Yesterday this page recorded **412,392 downloads against 85,275**. In one day the quantisation added about **479,000** and the original about **10,600**, so the ratio has gone from **4.8× to 9.3×**: **891,147 against 95,889**. It is not a fluke of one model. The same lab's build of Qwen3.8-Flash-Next sits at **7,089,722** downloads against **3,162,203** for the original. The thing people actually run is not the thing the labs publish.[1]

The "TBD" this page complained about yesterday has been filled in, and the explanation is architectural. The official release is **763,205,315,794 parameters** across 48 shards and **475 GiB** of storage. The quantised build splits it: a **551.9-billion-parameter backbone** at 1.75, 2.00 or 2.25 bits, plus a separate **196.6-billion-parameter Engram table** at 4.5 bits that is downloaded once and shared across all three. Totals: **231.32GB, 248.84GB, 265.83GB**.[2]

Then do not reuse a prompt. Issue 30944 on the llama.cpp tracker, opened 21 October and still open, reports single-token corruption on reused cached prefixes: the Engram history diverges from what the original forward pass saw, so row lookups land wrong. Measured: **one in twenty items corrupt on a fresh prefix, six in twenty on a reused one, none with the cache off**. It accumulates across runs.[3]

Yesterday **vikcious** confirmed it — "the same bug exists in Main, even after the today updated release" — and posted a context test in which **six of fifteen cases failed**. Asked whether such a test should have caught it, **ggerganov** said it "should", but "the dummy model may not be representative". Tonight's workaround is to send the prompt-cache flag as false where you need bit-exact output, and pay the re-prefill.[3]

THE CHATTER · THE LAB MADE THE RUNTIME BUILD THE LOADER

Nineteen threads in five days, most of them people unable to load the thing. The exchange that matters is thread 11. **am17an**, a llama.cpp collaborator: "Support is merged, it would be nice if you can re-upload and align with the unsloth tensor-naming scheme." **anm2211** of the Vienna lab declined, defending the separate Engram file on purpose so that engines would add support: "It really doesn't make sense to upload the same Engram file with every different bitwidth." am17an: "Yes sure that's a good point, I will add support for it."[4]

THE SCEPTIC · "100 PER CENT RECOVERY" IS THREE TASKS, ONCE

In thread 13, **DzmitryTheOtherOne** noticed the published table scores the 2.25-bit build *below* the 2.00-bit one. **anm2211** conceded it was "likely benchmark noise", that repeat runs are too costly, and that one unsolved problem flips the ranking. **TheStigma** pressed further: the benchmarks are too easy for models this size. **The honest reading of "100.0 per cent recovery" is "no measurable degradation on three benchmarks at one sample each"** — two already saturated.[5]

6 of 256

ACTIVE EXPERTS PER TOKEN IN RECURSIVE'S FLINT, A 40-BILLION-PARAMETER CODING MODEL THAT WENT FROM NOTHING TO THREE RUNTIMES IN FIVE DAYS[6]

ALSO ON THE BENCH

The hardware tax, and the used market above new. A listing-floor index dated 11 October puts the **RTX 5090** new floor at **US$4,920.99** against US$3,004 in August, up 64 per cent, with the used floor **US$958.81 above new**. The 4090's new floor is flat while its used floor is up 27 per cent to US$2,800. **Five models now ask more used than new.** These are asking prices, fifteen days stale, not transactions, and whether the 5090 is discontinued remains contradicted on the record.[7]

SOURCES 1 Hugging Face's model interface for both repositories, read 27 October; the prior day's figures are this magazine's own record in No. 144. 2 The repository README, read raw; totals from the safetensors index. 3 Issue 30944 on the llama.cpp tracker, read in full including the 26 October comments. 4 Discussion thread 11 in the same repository. 5 Discussion thread 13. 6 The model card and the runtime's release notes. 7 A dealer's listing-floor index — **asking prices, not sales, dated 11 October**. 8 Release notes on GitHub. **r/LocalLLaMA was not retrievable, so every community line above is first-party. No verified memory split or tokens-per-second figure exists for this model on any named machine, so none is printed.**

THE KIT · APPLE'S IPAD MINI

Apple gives only the 512GB iPad mini a second Neural Engine

The S$999 base model gets five CPU cores and one engine; Apple publishes no refresh rate for the new OLED panel at all, and Singapore pre-orders open at 1.10am on Thursday.

Apple announced a new iPad mini on Monday from Cupertino and had the Singapore store live the same evening, at **S$999** for the 128GB Wi-Fi model. Pre-orders open **1.10am Singapore time on Thursday**, with sale on **6 November** in thirty-six markets. The screen is now an **8.5-inch OLED** at 2316×1512, the body **5.4mm** against 6.3, the weight **255g**.[1]

Then read the specification table, which Apple does not summarise in its press release. The 128GB and 256GB models carry a **five-core CPU** — two performance, three efficiency — and **one sixteen-core Neural Engine**. The **512GB** model carries **six cores** and **two** Neural Engines. The graphics core count, seven, is the same throughout. Nothing on the page calls this a difference; the price does, at **S$1,449**.[2]

The second absence is louder. Apple publishes a refresh rate for the *external* display the tablet can drive — one screen, 4K, sixty hertz — and publishes none at all for the panel in the reader's hands. ProMotion is never named. Nor is the memory capacity, in the same week the company began advertising "over two times" the unified memory *bandwidth*, which is a rate measured against a number it will not give.[3]

On price the pre-launch reporting was wrong in the generous direction. Bloomberg's Mark Gurman had briefed "considerably more expensive" and the trade had converged on **US$799**; Apple shipped at **US$699**. Measured against the previous generation's US$599, the same 128GB still costs a hundred dollars more. The nano-texture glass is a flat **S$150**, and only on the two larger tiers.[4]

THE CHATTER · HACKER NEWS READ THE TABLE FIRST

The binning was found by readers, not reviewers. On Hacker News **jeffbee** posted that "it looks like the base model of the new iPad is using binned CPUs", and **SirMaster** confirmed the 512GB got the better part. Two threads ran that morning, at **119 and 154 points**. **sheepscreek**: "They should stop handicapping the non-Pro displays at 60hz refresh rate." **twidtwid** called US$699 for 128GB "wild".[5]

THE SCEPTIC · NOBODY HAS OPENED ONE

The sceptics were wrong last month and may be wrong again. 9to5Mac treated the 60Hz leak with "more than a healthy dose of skepticism" and the leak held; Cult of Mac predicted the price would deter buyers and Apple came in a hundred dollars under the rumour. **The falsification test is a teardown.** If the panel is a tandem LTPO held at sixty hertz in firmware, a later toggle is possible; if it is a hybrid LTPS that cannot go faster, it never arrives. No unit reaches a buyer before **6 November**.[6]

S$450

THE GAP BETWEEN THE FIVE-CORE 128GB MINI AND THE SIX-CORE 512GB ONE — A STORAGE PRICE LIST THAT IS ALSO A SILICON PRICE LIST[2]

ALSO ON THE BENCH

Sigma's new CL line — the 50mm F1.4 CL DG Contemporary, announced 23 October: nine elements, **fourteen rounded blades**, 375g, a 52mm filter thread, and **no price and no date** on Sigma's own page. DPReview, which was briefed, says early spring 2027. The stated design brief is character over sharpness; the MTF is published as pictures of charts.[7]

The touchscreen Mac is tomorrow. Apple's Los Angeles press event runs Wednesday 10am Pacific, with OLED touch MacBook Pros expected on M5 Pro and M5 Max. The figures in circulation — US$2,999 and US$3,499 — are labelled "just guesses" by the journalist who published them. **This page is not printing a price.**[8]

Kindle Colorsoft at US$289.99 for 16GB, US$319.99 Signature, shipping 28 October — **single-sourced to BGR**; Amazon has published nothing.[9]

SOURCES 1 Apple Newsroom, 26 October 2026, and apple.com/sg/ipad-mini/specs, both read in full. 2 The core counts are Apple's own per-capacity specification table; the S$ prices are the Singapore store's ten published SKUs, which the newsroom release reduces to "from". 3 Absence verified by reading the whole spec page: the only refresh figure given is the external display's. 4 9to5Mac, 11 October, for the pre-launch US$799 consensus. 5 Hacker News items 50243061 and 50243646, read directly. **MacRumors' forums returned 403, so their parallel threads are not quoted here.** 6 9to5Mac, 8 October; Cult of Mac's pre-launch piece. 7 sigma-global.com lens page c027_50_14 and DPReview's briefing, both read. 8 9to5Mac, 25 October — the author's own caveat. 9 BGR, 5 October. **One source only; treat the figure as reported.**

THE GOOD LIFE · THE AQUIS KELP FOREST

Oris prices the Aquis Kelp Forest at US$2,950; two outlets print less

Oris's own site says two thousand nine hundred and fifty dollars; Fratello reports 2,450 Swiss francs; and one magazine prints £2,250 in its body copy and the franc figure in its own spec box, in the same article.

Oris published the **Aquis Date Kelp Forest Limited Edition**, reference 01 733 7787 4187-Set, in a run of **1,000 pieces**, and put **USD 2,950.00** on its own product page. The watch is a **41.5mm** multi-piece steel case with a green ceramic minutes ring, sapphire domed both sides, **300 metres** of water resistance, and a **3D-printed** green dial. Oracle of Time supplies the geometry Oris does not publish: **12.9mm thick, 49mm lug to lug** — which is why it will wear smaller than the number suggests.[1]

Inside is **Calibre 733-1**, the Sellita SW200-1: four hertz, **41 hours** of reserve, instantaneous date, stop-seconds. What Oris does not print anywhere: a Singapore price, a launch date, the case thickness, the lug-to-lug, or any accuracy specification.[1]

So three figures are in public circulation for one watch, and the maker's own is the highest. **USD 2,950** at Oris; **CHF 2,450** attributed as the Swiss retail price; and **£2,250** stated in a magazine's prose while the spec box beside it carries the franc. Nobody explains the contradiction, including the publication contradicting itself. The conversions those outlets print put the franc figure near the dollar one, which suggests a currency rendered twice rather than a price cut — but that is inference, not a published fact.[2]

The audio release of the week has the same shape and less of a floor under it. **Audio-Technica** showed the **ATH-AWX7000** closed-back wood flagship to press in Paris on 23 October, reported at **€3,799** by one outlet and **$3,799** by another. Its published measurement set is three numbers: **48 ohms, 97dB per milliwatt, about 353 grams**. No frequency response on the spec sheet, no distortion, no isolation figure, no independent measurement by anyone. **Audio-Technica's own pages returned 403 twice and no press release could be found.**[3]

THE CHATTER · EVERYONE LIKES THE DIAL, NOBODY LIKES THE MOVEMENT

Ten comments under Fratello's piece split cleanly. **AnPucaGlas**: "This is one of the best interpretations of a nature inspired dial that I've seen in a long time." **xbarx1** caught the dial text — "Pressure Resistant is an odd callout" — then conceded it was another way of saying depth rating. **166293** supplied the caveat: "If the dial color is in reality only half as beautiful as in press release..." And **tarartrat2112** gave the counter-case in two words: "It's okay."[4]

THE SCEPTIC · THE COMPLAINT IS THE CALIBRE, AND IT IS CORRECT

MarkBu, under the same piece: "Still using the old SW200-1 movement, tsk, tsk." He is right on the facts — Oris's own page confirms the base and the **41-hour** reserve, which does not survive a weekend off the wrist. On the Audio-Technica there is **no researched dissent at all, because nobody has measured it**; the enthusiast boards produced nothing in four days, which for a flagship is itself a finding. The falsification test is a graph: a frequency and distortion sweep showing the 58mm hybrid diaphragm doing nothing a thousand-euro driver cannot. Until someone publishes one, the case for €3,799 rests on cypress, lacquer and deerskin.[5]

Three prices

ONE WATCH, ONE THOUSAND PIECES, AND NO TWO OUTLETS AGREEING ON WHAT IT COSTS — THE MAKER'S OWN FIGURE THE DEAREST OF THE THREE[2]

STILL ON THE SHELF

A deadbeat seconds with a stop-seconds function. Arnold & Son's DSTB Stop-Seconds in platinum, **US$72,500** in eighteen pieces, puts a true dead-beat train on the dial side — the movement release of the week in a round-up of thirty. The cheapest in-house perpetual calendar on the same list is Frederique Constant's at **US$12,995**, an order of magnitude under the rest.[6]

SOURCES 1 oris.ch's product page for reference 01 733 7787 4187-Set, read 27 October; thickness and lug-to-lug from Oracle of Time, 26 October. 2 The three figures as each outlet publishes them; the contradiction sits within one article. **The currency inference is this desk's and is marked as inference.** 3 Two independent outlets, 23–26 October; the photographed unit carries the model number on its hanger. **Audio-Technica's pages returned 403 twice and no press release was found — the price is reported, not confirmed. The frequency figure one outlet carries is last year's open-back model's, so it is not printed.** 4 The comment thread under Fratello's article. **A German forum returned 403.** 5 Oris's own page; the falsification test is this desk's. **Head-Fi returned a bot check.** 6 A round-up of 25 October, which gives no per-watch announcement dates. 7 The house's own sale page; **a lot page returned 404**.

SCREEN & SOUND · CLAYFACE

Rotten Tomatoes has Clayface at 76 per cent; Metacritic has 59

The same corpus of 44 critics holds a 20 from Rolling Stone and four separate 80s; the film opened to US$24m from 3,458 theatres, and LAIKA's 99-per-cent Wildwood came third behind it.

Warner Bros. opened **Clayface** wide on 23 October and it took an estimated **US$24,000,000** from **3,458** theatres, first place for the weekend. Rotten Tomatoes certifies it fresh at **76 per cent from 171 reviews**, with an audience score of **94**. Metacritic, reading the same kind of notices, publishes **59 from 44 critics** and badges it "mixed or average". Seventeen points apart on one film.[1]

The gap is structural, not mysterious. Metacritic's own breakdown is **23 positive, 18 mixed, 3 negative**: Rotten Tomatoes counts those eighteen mixed notices as fresh thumbs and renders three-quarters approval, while Metacritic scores them in the fifties and drags a mean down. So nearly half the critical corpus is unenthusiastic, and the headline number cannot show it.[1]

Inside the sample the extremes are far apart. The high is **91**, from Original-Cin's John Kirk; the low is a **20**, from Rolling Stone's David Fear, which is the lowest of 44 notices on a Certified Fresh film. The reliable middle is a tight, unexcited cluster of eighties — The Telegraph, Time Out, The Hollywood Reporter and Variety all at **80**, then 78, then three at 75. James Watkins directed, from a screenplay by Mike Flanagan and Hossein Amini; Tom Rhys Harries leads. Rated R.[2]

The week's better film finished third. LAIKA's **Wildwood**, which this page recorded at a hundred per cent from 117 notices on Friday, now reads **99 per cent from 124** — and **87 from 36** at Metacritic, with **zero negative reviews** in the set. It took **US$11,600,000** from 2,942 theatres: a per-theatre average of **US$3,943**, the weakest in the top five, behind a 76-per-cent comic-book picture at US$6,942 and a Nathan Fielder documentary at **US$7,345** in its second weekend on 803 fewer screens.[3]

THE CHATTER · LETTERBOXD REACHED FOR BODY HORROR

The audience is not watching a superhero film. **realgsmirk**, five stars: "This is the best Clayface movie ever." **anto**, four: "imagine Batman having to deal with this shit on a random Friday". **Alucard**, four: "Clayvicular — The dangers of Looksmaxxing." The comparison that recurs, and the most useful critical read in the sample, is to *The Substance*. Which tracks the 94-per-cent audience score against the 59 exactly: they came for the transformation, not the cape. Letterboxd lists **1,800 fans** and, oddly, **publishes no average rating at all**.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · REVIEWS DID NOT SELL A TICKET

A 99-per-cent, universally-acclaimed stop-motion feature, sixteen years in the making, opened third on the weakest screen average in the top five. If reviews moved tickets, that sentence could not be written. **The falsification test is dated:** a film that good should have legs, so check the second weekend. A drop steeper than 35 per cent confirms the reading; a hold above 60 per cent, or a run through the school holidays, kills it. **And a caution on this desk's own sceptic:** Rolling Stone's 20 appears on Metacritic's main page, not in the critic listing, and the publication's own page redirects to a paywall proxy. It is reported, not read.[5]

US$3,943

PER-THEATRE AVERAGE FOR THE BEST-REVIEWED WIDE RELEASE OF THE MONTH, AGAINST US$6,942 FOR THE ONE ABOVE IT[3]

IN BRIEF

23 October was a reissue week. New albums from John Legend, cut with Pharrell Williams in a studio inside Louis Vuitton's Paris headquarters; Michael Kiwanuka's first since a stroke this year; Anderson .Paak with Cordae; Polyphia; Tony Iommi. Alongside them, twentieth-anniversary editions of *Back to Black* — unreleased demos, the complete B-sides, a 2007 Amsterdam live set — and *The Black Parade*. **No first-week figure exists for any of them; the chart week does not report until November, so none is printed.**[6]

SOURCES 1 rottentomatoes.com and metacritic.com, read 27 October, with the positive/mixed/negative split as Metacritic publishes it; the gross from Box Office Mojo — **estimates, per the page's own key, not actuals**. 2 Individual scores from Metacritic's critic listing; credits read off the verified one-sheet. 3 Per-theatre figures are this magazine's own division; the hundred-per-cent reading is its record from No. 144. 4 letterboxd.com's film page, each review with its author's handle. 5 The second-weekend test is this desk's. **Rotten Tomatoes' rotten-review filter rendered no text, so its negative critics cannot be named; Reddit refused this desk for the twelfth issue running.** 6 **Two Netflix debut dates conflict by two days and are not printed.** 7 The quarterly exhibit as filed; the 9.7 per cent is this magazine's own division.

THE FAMILY DESK · THE BAND PROBLEM

Frontiers in Pediatrics splits the screen-and-ADHD odds: 2.40 under six, 1.16 over

Zhao and colleagues pooled ten studies and 232,125 children on 28 September; the headline odds ratio of 1.56 sits on heterogeneity of 97.4 per cent, and the alarming figure belongs entirely to toddlers.

On 28 September, Zhao, Xu, Wu and Li published in *Frontiers in Pediatrics* a meta-analysis of **ten observational studies — seven cross-sectional, three cohort — totalling 232,125 children** aged nought to seventeen, on screen time and attention-deficit disorder. The pooled odds ratio is **1.56**, with a confidence interval of 1.31 to 1.87. That is the number a headline will take, and heterogeneity across the ten studies is **97.4 per cent**, which is about as high as that statistic goes.[1]

Split it by age and the pooled figure dissolves. The four studies of children **under six** give an odds ratio of **2.40** (1.44 to 3.98). The six studies of children **over six** give **1.16** (1.05 to 1.29). The difference between the groups is itself significant, at **p equals 0.006**. The alarm belongs to preschoolers. For a twelve-year-old the number is 1.16, and that is the paragraph the coverage will not write.[1]

The authors are candid about what the paper cannot do. Seven of ten studies are cross-sectional, so no causal claim survives. "Excessive" screen use is defined anywhere between one and four hours a day across the ten. The media subgroups rest on two studies each; **passive television gives 2.20 with an interval from 0.81 to 6.03**, crossing one; the passive-against-interactive difference is not significant; **no dose-response was possible**; the protocol was not registered in advance. One publication-bias test comes back clean, the other at **p equals 0.020**. No funding, no declared conflicts.[1]

Two other findings from the same three weeks are worth the band. A Wayne State umbrella review of delayed school start times, published 17 October, found all **nine** reviews concluding sleep duration probably rises — and the authors of all nine "usually recommended **limited** adoption rather than wide-spread adoption", because the gains were modest, there is no evidence they persist, and the primary studies are weak. Their moderator analysis failed outright for missing data. **No minutes figure appears in the abstract, so none is printed here.**[2]

THE CHATTER · A NULL NOBODY WILL QUOTE

From Manaus, on 23 October, a structural-equation study of **610 twelve-year-olds** — a sample of exactly this band — in the *Journal of Dental Research*. Its first finding is the null: **screen time was not directly associated with any clinical oral condition.** What it did find ran through the household: screen time to lower toothbrushing frequency, −0.139; screen time to a worse oral quality-of-life score, 0.202; and that score to higher sugar consumption and poorer clinical condition. The authors point the intervention at the family and the income gradient, **not at the screen**.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · THREE RESEARCHERS SAYING ONE PER CENT

On the big September umbrella review of 2.8 million children, three named academics went on the record the day it published. **Dr Tatiana Íñiguez Berrozpe** of Zaragoza put the association at "very small, around **1 per cent** of group differences", said the striking emotional and peer effects "rest on few studies with high variability", and made the point that matters: screen-time studies **rarely control for household income**, so part of the signal may be inequality wearing a device. **Prof Esther van Sluijs** of Loughborough: it "cannot draw robust conclusions about specific types of screen use". **Dr Víctor González Calatayud** of Murcia: it does not account for purpose, content or interaction.[4]

97.4%

HETEROGENEITY BEHIND THE POOLED 1.56 — TEN STUDIES THAT DISAGREE WITH EACH OTHER, AVERAGED INTO ONE FIGURE[1]

SOURCES 1 Zhao C, Xu J, Wu X, Li Y, *Frontiers in Pediatrics* 2026;14:1860549, published 28 September — read in full through the National Library of Medicine, subgroup, sensitivity and bias sections included. 2 Floyd JA and colleagues, *Sleep Medicine Reviews* 2026;90:102379, 17 October. **The number of primary studies is not in the abstract and the full text is paywalled, so it is not given.** 3 Rego IN and colleagues, *Journal of Dental Research*, 23 October; **limitations, funding and conflicts are paywalled.** 4 All three statements made to the Science Media Centre on 28 September. 5 Both author lists read at source. **Four studies published in October contain a twelve-year-old at all.**

THE TWEEN YEARS · THE APP-STORE AUDIT

Singapore's first app-store audit found 65 harmful apps across Apple, Google and Huawei

The media regulator's inaugural report, out on 24 October, mystery-shopped more than 7,000 apps across five stores; 24 were rated for the wrong age, and two stores let minors past the eighteen-plus gate.

Singapore's media regulator published its first **Online Safety Assessment Report** for app distributors on **24 October**, having mystery-shopped **more than 7,000 apps** across the **Apple App Store, Google Play, Huawei AppGallery, Microsoft Store and Samsung Galaxy Store** over an audit window of April to December 2025. It found **65 apps carrying harmful content** and **24 rated for the wrong age**.[1]

The categories are specific: artificial-intelligence "nudification" apps generating non-consensual sexual images; gambling-themed games with payouts; depictions of crime and drug use; firearms in a school setting. On the gate itself, **Huawei's AppGallery and the Microsoft Store did not reliably keep under-eighteens out of adult apps** — some Huawei versions allowed the age check to be bypassed. Huawei has resolved it. **Microsoft has an interim fix, with a permanent one pending.**[1]

Here is the part a parent should take away. All 65 apps came down and all 24 were re-rated **after the regulator told the stores**. Age assurance has been mandatory here since **1 April 2026**, and the methods differ by shop: Apple accepts a credit card or government identity document, Samsung and Huawei a credit card, Google analyses account activity with a selfie-to-document or card as fallback. So the rating on the app a twelve-year-old downloads this afternoon is a publisher's claim that a regulator checks in arrears, not an independent guarantee at the moment of download.[2]

Which is why the body, not the birthday, is the better guide at this age. On 6 October, Chad, Klukas, Ghasoub and Lebel published in *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience* a paper titled, in their own words, **"Puberty, not age, marks the start of adolescent brain structural remodeling"**. Using three waves of structural imaging in children aged **nine to fourteen**, and comparing **age-matched** children who had or had not reached a pubertal milestone, they found widespread contraction of cortical surface area and subcortical volume **only** in those who had — more pronounced in girls. Two children of the same age in one classroom are not at the same stage.[3]

THE CHATTER · THE REGULATOR'S OWN WORDS, AND A PILOT

The regulator is quoted as finding "room for improvement in removing apps with harmful content and ensuring apps are age-rated appropriately", and says it "will continue to hold" the distributors responsible. **No official is named in either account this desk read.** Alongside it: a pre-school safety pilot scaling to **3,000** pupils across thirty centres from December, and a consultation of more than **2,000** parents and young people.[1]

THE SCEPTIC · THE STUDY EVERYONE QUOTED IS THREE YEARS TOO OLD

This desk held an item yesterday on a mean age of 14.8. It is now identified: Zhao, Hale and Christakis, JAMA *Pediatrics*, 19 October — **425 participants, 7,591 person-nights**, phone use sensed passively and sleep by wristband. **Mean age 14.8, standard deviation 1.1.** The sample's centre is nearly three years past a twelve-year-old, and at this age that is most of a developmental stage. It is a good study about fifteen-year-olds. **The honest finding of three weeks' reading is that the twelve-to-thirteen window is comparatively empty, and the field's October output clusters at fourteen to fifteen** — two separate papers landing within a tenth of a year of each other.[4]

65 and 24

HARMFUL APPS REMOVED, AND WRONG AGE RATINGS CORRECTED — ALL OF THEM AFTER THE REGULATOR ASKED, NONE OF THEM BEFORE[1]

SOURCES 1 The report's findings read in full at three independent outlets on 24 October, two quoting the regulator directly. **The regulator's own release page serves no text to any fetcher, so the report was not read on its own domain.** 2 The mandatory-assurance date and per-store methods from a law firm's published analysis. 3 Chad JA and colleagues, *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience* 2026;82:101835, 6 October. **The record gives only "thousands of participants", so no sample size is printed.** 4 Zhao Y, Hale L, Christakis DA, *JAMA Pediatrics*, 19 October. 5 The ministry's release of 30 November 2025; **nothing newer on screen use exists in its newsroom.**

THE MACRO DESK · THE EVE OF THE FOMC

The Treasury ten-year closed at exactly 5.00% on the eve of the FOMC

The ten-year breakeven has not moved from 2.34% since Friday, which leaves a real yield of 2.66%; one monitor prices Wednesday's hold at 88.5 per cent, and the CME's own tool refused this desk for a second day.

The chain runs one way and has just begun to run back. Missiles put a premium into crude; crude went into the petrol line of September's consumer-price print; the print turned the committee hawkish; the hawks produced a five-per-cent nominal yield that is almost all *real*; gold and bitcoin are paying for it. On Monday oil rolled over, which unwinds the first link.[1]

Start with the print. September's figures, released 14 October, gave headline inflation **+0.6 per cent on the month, 3.7 on the year**, core **+0.3 and 2.6**, petrol **+9.1 and +34.2**. Core sits **110 basis points below headline** — an energy shock wearing a consumer-price costume. The committee tightened into it anyway: sixteen of eighteen participants projected one more hike this year, and fourteen see four per cent or higher through end-2027, against three in June.[2]

Which is why the breakeven is the number to watch. The ten-year was **2.32 on Thursday, 2.34 on Friday, 2.34 on Monday**. Headline inflation is 3.7 per cent and the market will not price it past 2.34. Subtract that from a **5.00 per cent** nominal and the real rate is **2.66**. The bond market is telling the committee that a 34-per-cent rise in petrol is a relative price, not a regime.[3]

A 2.66 per cent real rate is the charge on everything that needs cheap money. December gold ran from **4,160.10 on 19 October to 4,031.00**, down 3.1 per cent on the week. Bitcoin is below eighty thousand, at **US$79,815**. World equity, read through VWRA at **US$190.10**, is **6.0 per cent below its 52-week high** — Monday's bounce in New York is a bounce inside a drawdown.[4]

THE STRIP · AT MONDAY'S CLOSE

VWRA	$190.10	▲ 0.26%
AGGU	$5.798	▲ 0.14%
US 10-year	5.00%	flat
10-yr breakeven	2.34%	flat
DXY	102.01	▲ 0.20%
USD/SGD	1.2793	▲ 0.20%
Brent	$115.81	▼ 0.78%
Gold (Dec)	$4,031.00	▼ 3.10% wk
STI	5,415.91	▼ 0.12%

Each level read at its own source on 26 October; **bitcoin US$79,815, down 0.72 per cent**. The real yield is this magazine's own subtraction of two published curves. **Not advice.**[4]

THE VERDICT · WHAT IT MEANS FOR THE FOUR

Higher-for-longer, dollar-bid, liquidity-tight, with a risk-on topcoat exactly one day thick. For world equity the drag is the discount rate rather than earnings. For global bonds, a flat breakeven against a 3.7 per cent headline is the friendliest thing in the data: the carry is real, and the curve is steepening from the front. For gold, a 2.66 per cent real rate is a straight headwind, and it showed — minus 3.1 per cent in a week with two wars running. For bitcoin the same tight-liquidity reading, amplified: below eighty thousand on a day equities rose. **Explanation, not advice.**[5]

THE SCEPTIC · "I WOULDN'T BE SURPRISED BY ANYTHING"

Arlan Suderman of StoneX is sceptical in both directions. He sees "signs that inflation risks are rising as high energy costs that first showed up at the fuel pump" spreading wider — the second-round effects the it-is-only-energy camp waves off — and blames "two wars on commodity logistics". He still expects a hold: "my bias is that policymakers will show restraint at this meeting." And then the line this desk would print above any probability: **"I wouldn't be surprised by anything."**[6]

88.5% hold

AND 11.5 ON A HIKE, ZERO ON A CUT, FOR WEDNESDAY — UP FROM 10.3 A DAY EARLIER, DOWN FROM 18.4 A WEEK EARLIER. **THE CME'S FEDWATCH RETURNED 503 FOR A SECOND DAY; THIS IS ANOTHER VENUE'S TAPE**[7]

SOURCES 1 The weekend's interceptions and the reserve authorisation via market reporting. 2 Bureau of Labor Statistics release of 14 October, read at source; the committee's September projections via a bank's summary. 3 Breakeven and curve series from the St Louis Fed's CSV; the ten- and two-year from the Treasury's daily file. 4 Each level read at its own source and stamped. **The real yield, the 2s10s and the implied-odds check are this magazine's own arithmetic.** 5 This desk's reading. **Market explanation, not investment advice.** 6 StoneX commentary, 13:33 on 26 October. 7 A rate monitor stamped 16:55 Eastern, cross-checked against the front federal-funds future at 96.095, implying about ten per cent — **the contract month is not stated, so it is a check, not a second print.** A hundred-economist poll has 94 expecting no change.

THE RABBIT HOLE · COMPETITIVE BARBECUE

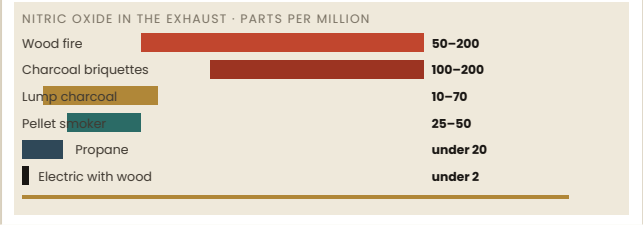
Greg Blonder measured a brisket stalling at 153°F for almost six hours

A retired Bell Labs physicist ruled out rendering fat and melting collagen by experiment: the stall is evaporative cooling, the meat behaving as a wet-bulb thermometer — and wrapping cuts a pork shoulder from almost fourteen hours to about ten.

Three crafts share one word, and the people inside them do not always consider each other colleagues. **Grilling** is direct radiant heat, minutes, 230–315°C at the grate. **Low-and-slow smoking** is indirect convection in a sealed chamber at **107–135°C for six to eighteen hours**. **Live fire** — the Argentine *asado* — is a third thing: embers raked under a grate whose height is cranked by a wheel, heat managed by **distance** rather than damper. No stall, no bark, no smoke ring, no clock.[1]

The stall is what separates barbecue from roasting, and it was settled by experiment rather than lore. **Greg Blonder**, a retired Bell Labs physicist, watched a brisket probe sit at **153°F for almost six hours** in a 225°F smoker, then took the folk explanations apart. A block of beef fat kept climbing while a wet sponge stalled, *dipped*, then climbed once dry. Rendering was ruled out: a pool of rendered fat had formed while the temperature still rose. A solid rib roast stalled two hours; the same meat, ground, did not stall at all.[2]

His conclusion: the meat is a wet-bulb thermometer. Evaporative cooling from its own moisture rises until it cancels heat input, and the reading flatlines until the surface runs dry. It is why wrapping works: two three-pound shoulders at 230°F reached tenderness in **about ten hours wrapped against almost fourteen naked**. **Bark**, likewise, is not a crust but a pellicle of cross-linked surface protein **under a millimetre thick**, and the **smoke ring** is nitric oxide binding myoglobin, not smoke at all.[2]



The smoke ring is nitric-oxide chemistry, so the fuel decides how much of it there is. *Meridian* original, plotted from Greg Blonder's own exhaust measurements.[3]

THE CHATTER · THE GATEWAY IS ALWAYS THE FIRST BRISKET

The pattern is consistent: a kettle or a cheap offset, a fourteen-hour Saturday, a three a.m. alarm, and a slice that bends. The live threads on the Pitmaster Club's competition board are titled **"First Comp - Let the Adventure Begin"** (64 replies) and **"Am I Crazy - Ironman Competition for first competition"**. The on-ramp to *competing* is social, not technical. A Singapore version exists — **Jayce Ho** of SGBrisketKitchen began with about **S$500** and a Weber Smokey Joe a neighbour gave him, and by 2025 was selling out online in under two minutes.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · THE BELOVED IRRELEVANCE

The smoke ring is cosmetic, and the people who measure it say so. Cook's Country puts a typical ring at **a quarter of an inch** and states flatly that **"the color change does not change the flavor"**. Even where it stops is disputed in good faith: Cook's Country puts myoglobin browning at **140°F**, Blonder the molecule falling apart near **160°F**. **Both are printed here because neither has been shown wrong.** And an acidic rub thins the ring sharply while an alkaline one nearly triples it — so the hobby's favourite proof of good smoking is substantially a pH trick.[3]

US$4–5bn

THE AMERICAN GRILL MARKET A YEAR, ON ESTIMATES THAT **DISAGREE WITH EACH OTHER BY A FACTOR OF THREE** DEPENDING ON WHAT IS COUNTED — ONE RESEARCH HOUSE SAYS 4.8 BILLION, A MANUFACTURING-ONLY INDEX SAYS 1.6[5]

What the next two pages descend into: where this world gathers and argues; the gear, from a S$210 portable to a **US$56,975** Argentine grill, with the lead times and the deposits; the rulebook that decides what competition food tastes like; and whether a country that allows a barbecue pit for ten and a half hours can cook a brisket.

SOURCES 1 The three-craft distinction and the parrilla's mechanics from the hobby's own literature and a Wikimedia file description of a documented asado. 2 Greg Blonder, "Waiting for 'Q'", genuineideas.com, July 2011, read in full — every experiment above is his, described in his own account. 3 Blonder, "Watching Paint Dry" (February 2013) and "Nitric Oxide Smoke Ring" (May 2014), both read in full; the quarter-inch figure and the quoted line from Cook's Country, 14 July 2022. **The 140°F against 160°F disagreement is real and is printed rather than resolved.** 4 The forum thread titles and reply counts read on the Pitmaster Club's competition board on 26 October; the Singapore account from a business-press interview of 24 June 2025. **Reddit is hard-blocked for this desk, so every subscriber figure on the next page is a third-party tracker's and is labelled as one.** 5 Four market estimates compared; **the disagreement is the honest finding and is printed as the number.**

THE DEEP END · THE GEAR AND THE WAIT

MAK Grills closed in 2026, ending parts and support for its owners

A Best Value award-winner selling American-made stainless cookers at US$3,499 to US$4,499 simply stopped; owners are now cross-shopping a rival's ignitor, and Franklin Barbecue Pits is sold out for the rest of the year at US$5,150.

Start with the map, because it is not the one the marketing draws. The Pitmaster Club's board post counts are an honest census of what this hobby *does*. One consumer product — the **Pit Barrel Cooker**, a US$400 drum — carries **33,614 posts**. Big Green Egg's board has 1,622; Komodo Kamado's 609 across ten topics. Competitive cooking, judging and organising **combined** come to **3,161**.[1]

The ladder, at real prices. **Kamado:** Big Green Egg Large **US$1,199.99** through a dealer who is also your warranty; Kamado Joe Classic III **US$2,199.99**, and **both fan-controlled models are sold out**. **Pellet:** Yoder's YS640s at **US$2,699**; Yoder publishes no price itself, a retailer does. **Offset:** Lone Star Grillz **US$2,295** to **US$7,195**; Workhorse 1957 **US$2,667**; Mill Scale's 94 Gallon **US$4,920**, its Gold Series **US$10,000** for the same capacity in a different finish.[2]

Commissioning one is the part nobody describes honestly, so here it is in the builders' own words. **Lone Star Grillz:** twelve to eighteen weeks on 24-inch offsets. **Workhorse Pits:** "any smoker in 110 days or less" — and "you pay the full balance at purchase". **Stump's Smokers:** a **50 per cent deposit, 70 on custom**, then "Stump's does not guarantee completion or shipment on any particular date", "Deposits are non-refundable", "there are NO REFUNDS OR REBUILDS on any orders". **Komodo Kamado:** half down, balance on shipping, shipping every five weeks — you are buying a slot on a container. **Humphrey's raffled a build slot at thirty dollars.** It sold out.[3]

The last twelve months, named and dated. **ThermoWorks launched the Thermapen NANO in August at US$119**, reading in 0.4 seconds to ±0.3°C, shipping from this month — and the proof it is a real generational replacement is that the Thermapen ONE is now a **US$74 colour closeout**. The **SIZZLE at about US$45** removes the last excuse for a twelve-dollar thermometer. **Combustion's second-generation predictive probe**, US$149, puts **eight sensors along its length** to find the cold spot, which is a different claim from knowing a temperature. **Traeger launched the Westwood on 14 April at US$699.99** — in the same fiscal year as a **34.3 per cent** revenue fall and a one-for-fifty reverse split to hold its listing.[4]

THE CHATTER · THE PIT THAT FORBIDS LAZINESS

The best owner review here is a Pitmaster Club post on a **Franklin Barbecue Pit**: about **US$3,750 delivered**, after **two years on the waitlist**. Six hundred pounds of steel; "very moist meat and amazing bark"; "Overall, I love it and have no regrets." Then the honesty: "Some balk at the price:'feature' ratio, which I get," and the thing a buyer must know — "plan on tending the fire the whole cook (no set and forget!)", because there are **no dampers anywhere on it**. Another owner: "The flow pretty much keeps a novice from making mistakes."[5]

THE SCEPTIC · BUY ONCE, CRY ONCE — ASK A MAK OWNER

MAK Grills is gone. The Pitmaster Club's notice: "MAK Grills is no more. They have ceased operations, support, and all customer service." A brand carrying a Best Value award, selling American-made stainless cookers at **US$3,499 to US$4,499** — precisely the purchase the buy-once ethos recommends. An owner whose ignitor failed found a rival's part "did not work well"; a forum is kept alive "to serve as a support group for these grills". **Orphan risk is a real cost, and the community almost never prices it.** Two more competition marques now redirect their domains elsewhere. **No primary statement exists — no press release, no closure date — and this page says so.**[6]

33,614 against 3,161

FORUM POSTS ABOUT A US$400 DRUM, AGAINST EVERY POST ABOUT COMPETING, JUDGING AND ORGANISING COMBINED[1]

SOURCES 1 Board post counts read on the Pitmaster Club index, 26 October; the combined competition figure is this magazine's own addition of its three boards. 2 Prices read at each maker's own site on 26 October except Yoder's, which publishes none — those are a specialist retailer's US figures, and **Canadian listings run far higher and are not mixed in**. 3 Every lead time and deposit term quoted verbatim from the builder's own page. **Mill Scale, Moberg, Shirley and Primitive publish none at all; Deep South returned 503.** 4 Maker pages, 26 October. **One controller tagged "New" was announced in July 2024; the tag is stale and is not repeated here as news.** 5 The thread read in full. 6 The club's own closure notice; the ignitor account is **snippet-level after a 403**.

THE DEEP END · THE RULEBOOK AND THE PIT

A Singapore park pit runs noon to half past ten, which a brisket cannot

NParks charges S$12 to S$20 for one fixed ten-and-a-half-hour slot, no portable stoves, nothing left overnight — and no fire authority, environment agency or housing rule anywhere forbids a home barbecue outright, which is a finding rather than a permission.

The rulebook is why competition food tastes as it does, and the weighting is what outsiders never learn. Six judges score **appearance, taste and tenderness** two to nine — threes and fours abolished, two means inedible, one is reserved for penalties. The multipliers are **0.56, 2.2972 and 1.1428**: roughly **fourteen, fifty-seven and twenty-nine per cent**. One judge's idiosyncrasy on taste moves a team further than every judge's opinion on appearance combined. Of six scores the lowest is discarded — except in a tie, where it breaks it.[1]

The rest is clock and paranoia. **Chicken at noon, ribs at half past, pork at one, brisket at half past one**; turn-in five minutes either side, late is zeros. A rosette of slices scores **a one on every criterion from all six judges**. Sauce goes on the meat, chunks "no larger than a fine dice". Gas inside the cooker is disqualification. And the economics fail for the organiser, not the cook: **Christie Vanover** published her own event's sums at **about US$18,000 before a dollar of purse**, and underpriced large spaces cut her projected prize money from US$20,000 to **US$8,500**. Against which, **44 spaces gone in ninety minutes**.[2]

Which brings it to a tropical island with no barbecue industry. **No fire-authority, environment-agency or housing rule specifically forbids a household barbecue** — the residential fire-safety guidance covers shoe racks and potted plants and says nothing about open flames. What binds is a **1.2-metre clear escape passage** and a ban on combustible materials in common corridors, which a charcoal smoker and a stack of wood plainly are. So you book a pit: **S$12 to S$20** a day, and one immovable slot, **noon to 10.30pm**, nothing left overnight. Ten and a half hours is a pork butt. It is not a brisket.[3]

Gear is thinner still. **Weber is the only major brand with a proper Singapore storefront** — Smokey Mountain 47cm **S$1,119**, and the 37cm Smokey Joe that started SGBrisketKitchen **S$210**. **No authorised Big Green Egg dealer could be confirmed anywhere in the region**, and there is no local equivalent of the American specialists. Serious kit arrives by personal import, by freight, or second-hand through the classifieds.[4]

THE CHATTER · POST OAK FLOWN TO THE EQUATOR

The doctrinal argument is wood, and Singapore stages it in miniature. **Jett Barbeque imports American post oak** — shipping firewood to the tropics. **SGBrisketKitchen** uses **longan and lychee** alongside American woods; **Meat Smith** smokes brisket on lychee. A divergence, not a compromise.[5]

THE SCEPTIC · "THE WINNERS ALL TASTE THE SAME"

The sport's own people say competition food is not good eating. Pitmasters in a Nashville interview: **"the winners all taste the same, and not necessarily in a good way"**. It is not a conspiracy; it is the rulebook working as designed. One bite, scored blind, by a judge who will eat twenty-three more boxes that afternoon, produces food sweeter, saltier and softer than anyone wants a plate of.[6]

NEXT DESCENTS

Marquetry & wood veneer inlay — the knife, the donkey, and pictures made of shaved trees.

Origami & paper craft — crease patterns, wet-folding, and the mathematicians who took over.

Darkroom printing — enlargers, fibre paper, and why the scan is not the print.

SOURCES 1 The 2026 Master Rules, effective 10 November 2025, read in full — every quoted phrase is the rulebook's. The multipliers are from a judging explainer updated 16 July 2026; **an older citation gives a different pair, and the current set is used.** 2 The organiser's own published sums; the per-contest team costs are **forum anecdote, not survey**. 3 The fire-safety guidance and the environment agency's page, both read at source — **the absence of any rule on open flames is reported as an absence, not as permission; the housing board's own rule could not be found and is not asserted.** 4 The parks board's barbecuing page and Weber's Singapore storefront, read 26 October. 5–6 The three operators from a business feature of 24 June 2025; the pellet and pitmaster quotations are **snippet-level after a 403 and a 429** and are marked as such.

FITNESS · THE TEMPUS TRIAL

Granada's TEMPUS trial finds time-restricted eating no better than usual care

Nature Communications published the four-arm trial on 14 October: 187 adults, twelve weeks, and the eight-hour window moved liver fat by −0.4 per cent against usual care, at p equals 0.93 — with no competing interests declared.

On 14 October, Clavero-Jimeno, Ruiz and twenty-six colleagues at the University of Granada published the **TEMPUS** trial: **187 adults with obesity**, half of them women, randomised for **twelve weeks** to usual care, an eight-hour eating window, supervised exercise, or both. The primary outcome was liver fat measured by imaging. Against usual care: the window **−0.4 per cent (p = 0.93)**, exercise **−0.8 (p = 0.54)**, both together **−1.1 (p = 0.28). And no significant difference between the three interventions either.**[1]

The exercise arm was not a token. Two supervised sessions a week, sixty to ninety minutes, about twenty-four in total: circuit resistance work at a rising perceived effort, then intervals — three or four bouts of four minutes at a high share of heart-rate reserve with four-minute recoveries — plus an escalating daily step goal. The window was self-selected, held within half an hour every day, last meal by nine. Recruitment ran from May 2023 and the trial finished in September 2025.[1]

Two things about this paper deserve printing beside the result. First, the funders "had no role in study design, conduct, analysis, or the decision to publish", and the declarations read **"The authors declare no competing interests"** — which is the exact opposite of the creatine trial this page covered on Friday, whose positive finding was a wristband company's own sleep score and one of whose co-authors held options in that company. **An industry-free null gets less coverage than a sponsored positive, and that asymmetry is the thing to watch for.** Second, the paper is titled "and cardiometabolic health" and its abstract reports only the liver-fat primary; the protocol lists a dozen secondary outcomes. That is a fair question for the authors.[2]

THE CHATTER · THE SCEPTICS OF THE OXYGEN NUMBER

The live argument in the longevity press is about what gets measured. **Eric Topol** of Scripps, writing in February, names the claim that maximal oxygen uptake is "the single greatest predictor of your lifespan" and calls it false — because the outcome evidence is for cardiorespiratory fitness in **METs on a treadmill**, not for the oxygen figure itself. His receipts: a meta-analysis of 33 studies and 102,980 people at 14 to 15 per cent lower mortality per MET; 122,007 treadmill-tested patients; a cohort of 750,000 veterans. By his count a 2024 review of 42 studies had **234 times more participants with MET-based fitness than with directly measured oxygen uptake**. On wristband estimates, he puts the mean absolute error at **7 to 16 per cent**, flattering the unfit and shortchanging the fit.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · THAT INTERVAL CANNOT BE RIGHT

The month's biggest fitness number is the ETHOS study, epub 6 October: **562,234 adults**, mean follow-up **10.2 years**, treadmill-tested, with each additional MET of fitness carrying **16 per cent lower hazard of death**, and adjusted ten-year mortality of **32.9 per cent in the least-fit quintile against 13.4** in the fit. Two cautions. The hazard ratio is published as **0.84 with a 95-per-cent interval of 0.838 to 0.842**, which is implausibly narrow for that estimate and should be queried before anyone sets it in type. And the improvement in actual prediction is a C-statistic moving **0.662 to 0.682**: real, small, and not the same thing as a 16-per-cent improvement in anyone's ability to predict their own death. **Topol's argument is not refuted by ETHOS. It is confirmed by it** — the thing with the outcome data behind it is a treadmill test.[4]

n = 27

A TWELVE-WEEK BEETROOT TRIAL IN RESISTANCE-TRAINED ADULTS OF MEAN AGE 56: THE TRAINING WORKED THROUGHOUT, AND SUPPLEMENTATION "DID NOT CONFER ADDITIONAL BENEFITS WITH ANY OF THE OUTCOMES"[5]

SOURCES 1 Clavero-Jimeno A, Ruiz JR and colleagues, *Nature Communications*, published 14 October; registration NCT05897073, read at three offsets with the protocol separately. **Mean age and BMI appear in neither; eligibility was 25–65 and BMI 30 to under 40, so no mean age is printed.** 2 The funding and competing-interests blocks read in the declarations; the comparison is to No. 144. 3 Eric Topol, *Ground Truths*, 23 February, read in full with its citations. 4 Myers J and colleagues, *Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise*, 6 October; **mean age and limitations are paywalled. The interval is reproduced exactly as published, with this desk's objection to it.** 5 Mueller BJ and colleagues, *European Journal of Applied Physiology*, 3 October; the null quoted verbatim from the abstract, **its effect sizes and conflicts paywalled. Reddit was unreachable, so the chatter box is the longevity press and its critics, and says so.**

THE DIARY · THREE DATES THAT CLOSE

Singapore's 2027 Grand Prix opens regular ticket sales on 11 November

Early Bird has already gone across every grandstand, per the organiser's own 5 October stamp; ART SG's half-price pass expires on 24 November, and the January sumo basho in Tokyo opens its advance sale on 5 December.

SINGAPORE

BOOK NOW · PLAN AHEAD

20–29 Nov — **Kalaa Utsavam · Indian Festival of Arts**
ESPLANADE · FROM S$29; *RAFTA RAFTA* S$57.20 · **FREE FAMILY STORYTELLING 21–29 NOV**

18 Nov–6 Dec — ***Eureka Day* · Singapore Repertory Theatre**
KC ARTS CENTRE · ON SALE · S$48–78, **YOUTH S$28 TUE–THU** · RATED ADVISORY — NOT A TWELVE-YEAR-OLD'S NIGHT

15–17 Jan — ★ **Evo Singapore 2027**
MARINA BAY SANDS EXPO, HALLS E&F · **SOLD ONLY THROUGH ONE TRAVEL PLATFORM**, QR AT THE BOX OFFICE · TEKKEN WORLD TOUR GLOBAL FINALS

21–24 Jan — ★ **ART SG 2027**
MARINA BAY SANDS EXPO · **EARLY-BIRD ENDS 24 NOV, 23:59** · FRI S$40, WEEKEND S$44, VERNISSAGE S$94 (USUALLY S$188) · **UNDER-16S FREE**

23 JAN — **Young K · YOUNGEST solo tour**
SINGAPORE · DATE CONFIRMED ON THE PROMOTER'S INDEX; **VENUE, PRICE AND ON-SALE ALL UNPUBLISHED**

13–18 Apr — ★ **Bruno Mars · The Romantic Tour**
NATIONAL STADIUM — FOUR NIGHTS, 13, 14, 17, 18 APR · **NO ON-SALE DATE OR PRICE ON EITHER OFFICIAL PAGE**

8–10 Oct — ★ **Singapore Grand Prix 2027**
MARINA BAY STREET CIRCUIT · **REGULAR SALE 10AM, 11 NOV** · STAMFORD FROM S$438, PADANG S$668, PIT S$888, TURN 1 S$1,528

JAPAN & THE REGION

WORTH THE FLIGHT

4–8 Nov — **Art Week Tokyo 2026**
56 VENUES — A RECORD · **GALLERIES FREE; THE WRISTBAND IS THE TRICK**, FREE AT ANY BUS STOP, AND THE BUS IS FREE 6–8 NOV

14–15 Nov — **Design Festa vol. 64**
TOKYO BIG SIGHT · ~6,500 BOOTHS A DAY · **¥800 ADVANCE TO 13 NOV, ¥1,000 AT THE DOOR**; TWO-DAY PASS ADVANCE ONLY, NO REFUNDS

30 Oct–11 Jan — **teamLab · Digitized Fukuoka Castle Ruins**
MAIZURU PARK, FUKUOKA · FROM ¥2,300 WEEKDAYS · **TEAMLAB'S OWN PAGE RENDERS TO ITS TITLE ONLY — DATES AND PRICES ARE A LISTINGS SOURCE**

10–24 Jan — ★ **Grand Sumo · Hatsu Basho**
RYŌGOKU KOKUGIKAN, TOKYO · **ADVANCE SALE OPENS SAT 5 DEC** · NOVEMBER'S FUKUOKA TOURNAMENT IS SOLD OUT ALL FIFTEEN DAYS, NO SAME-DAY SEATS

9–11 Apr — **Hong Kong Sevens · at Kai Tak**
KAI TAK STADIUM · "TICKETING DETAILS TO FOLLOW" — NO BALLOT, NO PRICES · **CLASHES WITH SUZUKA THAT WEEKEND**

PLANNING NOTES · MARK THE OPENING, NOT THE EVENT

11 November, 10am is the entire window for a 2027 Grand Prix grandstand: the Early Bird allocation is gone across every tier, per the organiser's own 5 October stamp. **24 November, 23:59** ends ART SG's early bird, which is quoted *per pair* — buy two and go twice; the under-sixteen pass is free. **5 December** is the hard one: January's Tokyo basho opens then, and the tournament running now in Fukuoka is sold out on every one of fifteen days with no same-day sales. Diary the opening, not the event.[1]

THE SCEPTIC · WHAT THIS PAGE COULD NOT CONFIRM

Most of the arena pop is missing from the left column, and the reason is sourcing, not scarcity. **The national ticketing site returned zero results** to every read and one international seller returned 403, so BTS's December nights, a Jay Chou run, Yoasobi and Maroon 5 are **unconfirmed at any primary source and therefore not listed. Christmas Wonderland has still published no 2026 dates** — its own site serves last year's closure page and the Gardens' calendar renders unfilled placeholders. **Chingay 2027 still has no dates.**[2]

SOURCES 1 Every row above was verified against a promoter, venue, organiser or official ticket page on 26–27 October, not an aggregator: the circuit's own grandstand page (which carries its own 5 October currency stamp), the fair's ticket page, the theatre's show page, the arts centre's festival pages, the tournament's official ticket service, the convention's own ticket page, the art week's ticket page, the fighting-game event's own site, and the artist's own tour page. 2 Named refusals, each attempted repeatedly: the national ticketing site rendered zero results on both its home and events paths; one international seller, the sports-hub site and a food platform returned 403; a resort operator's museum pages and a Tokyo museum returned 503, several with an hour's retry header. **Two dead entries stand in the ledger and appear nowhere above.** The November Fukuoka tournament is logged as unbookable rather than listed.

THE TABLE · FOUR NEW ROOMS

Petra opens at Dempsey in the room that killed Curly's inside six months

Antonio Miscellaneo's 119-seat Levantine restaurant opened on 24 October with Ottolenghi's former London head chef consulting on the salads; of this page's four rooms, only one has been reviewed by anybody at all.

Petra opened at 40C Harding Road on **24 October**, and it is the first serious departure from Italian food for **Antonio Miscellaneo**, the former software man turned pizzaiolo behind Casa Vostra and La Bottega. **Anas Shami** is executive chef; **Dawid Nowosadzki**, once head chef at Ottolenghi in London, consults — and Miscellaneo is explicit that he is "100 per cent the author of those salads". Eight thousand square feet, **119 seats**, an open pizza counter, a seafood counter, and a bread oven turning out sesame barbari and thin sangak in place of pita.[1]

It is **too new to call on the food**: everything in print is a launch preview, and nothing surfaced on the forums either, which is what a two-day-old restaurant looks like. What can be said is the room's history. It was **Curly's**, an all-day concept the same operating partner shut after concluding inside six months that it was not working. Breads S$11–12, a mezze trio S$32, a whole grilled lavrak for three or four S$108; guidance is **S$40–50 at lunch and S$60–80 at dinner**. Closed Tuesdays.[1]

The one room here that has actually been eaten and written up is **Dough**, which left CHIJMES on **16 August** after five years and reopened within a fortnight at Capitol Singapore. The Korean-inflected bakery-kitchen from the Glyph Supply team kept its bread programme and its sleepy mascot and changed its room entirely: a conservatory of hanging ferns, lime-green banquettes and a mosaic floor. The verdict is warm and measured rather than rapturous — the food "still recognisably Dough", the greener setting giving returning customers "something different without making the café feel unfamiliar", the chicken thigh now arriving with "a proper browned surface". Toasts **S$14–16**, mains **S$22–36**, about **S$30–40 a head**. The caveat from the old outlet still applies: **pastries can be gone by lunchtime**.[2]

Two more are coming rather than open. **Sogurt**, which opened Singapore's first self-service frozen-yoghurt shop on Bukit Timah Road in **March 2010** and grew to fifteen outlets before the wave broke, returns in **December** with a **102-seat** flagship at One Holland Village — self-serve again, a chocolate tap, and the original green-apple and peach-mango tarts back. **No opening day, no unit number and no price of any kind has been published.** And **SHAO @ Dempsey**, the Teochew group's fourth outlet, opened on **2 October** and is the thinnest-documented here: no prices, no hours, no named chef, no review, while its own site still calls the outlet "taking shape".[3]

THE BUZZ · THREE OF FOUR ARE "TOO NEW TO CALL"

This page says so rather than inventing a consensus. Petra is two days old; Sogurt has not opened; the Teochew room has traded three weeks with nothing but listings coverage. A trap worth naming: a well-known review of a similarly-named tapas bar is a **different business**. Only Dough has a published verdict, and the reviewer disclosed which dish was comped.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · A HUNDRED AND NINETEEN SEATS IN A ROOM THAT JUST FAILED

The honest question about Petra is the size of the bet: its operating partner killed a concept in the same 8,000 square feet inside six months, and the replacement seats 119 at S$60–80 a head before wine. **Booking is easy right now, and that is the finding.** On Sogurt, note what is unreconciled: the retail pints carry halal certification and the food press reports the brand as not certified, and **nobody has published the new shop's status either way**. **Instagram rate-limited this desk on every venue**, so the social half of the research is reported as thinner rather than filled in.[4]

DEMPSEY · LEVANTINE · TOO NEW TO CALL · OPENS DECEMBER · CALL, DO NOT CLICK

SOURCES 1 petrarestaurant.sg, a long interview with the chef-owner of 23 October, and an independent preview, read 26–27 October; the closure of the previous concept is stated by the operator. 2 A full review of 27 August, read end to end — including its own disclosure that one dish was comped; the closing date from the café's own announcement; the pastry caveat from a 2025 review of the former outlet. 3 Two food-press announcements of 14 October, read in full; **the mall publishes no store directory this desk could reach, so no unit number is printed, and two outlets disagree on the brand's peak size**. The Teochew group's own menu documents did not resolve, so no price range is given. 4 **Reddit is unreachable, Instagram returned 429 on every venue, and two local titles returned 403 — where this page says no chatter was found, it means not found, not absent.** A fifth candidate could not be verified to exist at all and was dropped. The table ledger was read before these venues were chosen.

THE UNDERCURRENT · NEPAL'S ELECTRIC KITCHEN

Infrared stove imports rose 204 per cent in Nepal in two months

Customs data for mid-July to mid-September count 41,229 infrared plates against 19,508 induction — because Nepali kitchens cook in round-bottomed aluminium that an induction coil physically cannot see, so a country is electrifying through the less efficient appliance.

The number that detonated the story is small and extremely specific. In the first two months of Nepal's fiscal year — mid-July to mid-September — the Department of Customs recorded **41,229 infrared cooking plates** entering the country, against 13,567 in the same two months a year before: up **203.9 per cent by unit and 254.6 per cent by value**. Induction hobs rose too, by 67.3 per cent to 19,508. Rice cookers rose 54 per cent. Infrared's share of all electric cooking plates went from **53.8 to 67.9 per cent** in a year.[1]

Infrared is the *worse* technology. An induction hob couples a magnetic field directly into the base of a ferrous pan and wastes very little; an infrared plate heats its own ceramic surface by radiation and then conducts into whatever is sitting on it. Lower efficiency, higher standing draw. Nepal is choosing it two to one, and the reason is in the cupboard rather than the catalogue.[1]

Nepali kitchens run on **round-bottomed, non-ferrous** vessels — aluminium and brass *karahi*, *tapke*, pressure cookers. Induction cannot read them: no flat base, no iron. **K.R. Khanal** of Ultra Group Nepal put it to Kantipur in nine words — "Induction stoves require compatible cookware" — and said infrared heats itself and works with everything. So an induction hob is two purchases and a learning curve; an infrared plate is one purchase at **2,500 to 2,800 rupees** and no change to anything else. The pot is deciding the country's energy transition.[2]

And it is not price that moved. It never was. Nepal Oil Corporation sells a 14.2-kilogram cylinder at an administered **2,060 rupees** and loses **411 rupees on each one** — eight to ten billion rupees a month. The price could not move, so the state rationed instead: from **13 March 2026**, after the Hormuz closure blew through a twenty-billion-rupee stabilisation fund, the corporation began selling **half-filled 7.1-kilogram cylinders**.[3]

That is the mechanism, and it is a mechanism about certainty rather than cost. A household that cannot tell whether gas will be *available* does not economise on gas; it buys a hedge. The hedge is capital, not fuel — a 2,500-rupee plate you buy once and keep forever. Which makes it **one-way**. Full cylinders came back on **15 July**; within two weeks the queues were back, with black-market cylinders reported at up to **7,000 rupees**, and every new queue converted more kitchens. When the gas returns, the plate stays on the counter, and the marginal meal has already moved.[3]

> ***"Relying solely on an electric stove is not a solution as electricity is also not regular."***

Then, on **26 August**, a glacial lake burst on the China–Nepal border and the Bhotekoshi flood took out twelve hydro projects of more than **400 megawatts** combined — a shortfall of 350 to 400, about a tenth of installed capacity — destroying Trishuli 3A, Devighat and the country's largest solar farm. Four days later the **Krishnabhir** section of the Prithvi Highway collapsed, cutting the Kathmandu Valley's main gas artery. Gas and electricity failed in the same fortnight. Only one of them had a second source: on **13 September** India began exporting up to **654 megawatts** north, eighteen hours a day, to 31 December.[4]

1,800 against 1,910

RUPEES OF GRID ELECTRICITY AGAINST THE PRICE OF THE CYLINDER IT REPLACES, PER EQUIVALENT MEGAJOULE. **NEPAL IS THE FIRST COUNTRY IN SOUTH ASIA WHERE THE GRID IS CHEAPER THAN SUBSIDISED GAS**[3]

SOURCES 1 Department of Customs figures as published by The Kathmandu Post on 5 October and by Kantipur in Nepali the same day, both read in full; the share calculation is this magazine's own arithmetic from their figures and is marked as derived. 2 Khanal and the retail prices from the Kantipur report; the efficiency account is standard physics, stated here rather than sourced to an interested party. 3 The corporation's losses, the administered price, the rationing dates and the black-market figure from Nepali press reporting of March to September, read at source. **nepaloil.com.np does not resolve from here, so no corporation primary source was read: every NOC figure above reaches this page through the Nepali press quoting it.** The energy-equivalence crossover is The Kathmandu Post's of 20 March. 4 Flood and export figures from The Kathmandu Post of 14 September and the Indian power ministry's approval as reported; **capacity-loss figures conflict across sources between 350 and 550 megawatts and are given as the range most outlets carry.**

So Nepal has swapped a dependence on Indian gas for a dependence on Indian electrons, and the question the next two dry seasons answer is whether that import window closes or becomes permanent — because the kitchens keep arriving.

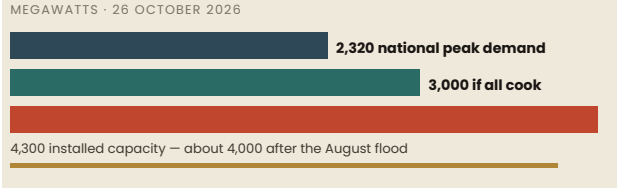
Here the sceptic is the outlet that broke the story. Nagarik News, running the same customs series under the headline "From the gas queue toward the electric stove", refused its own easy reading: **import data is not household adoption.** Stock may sit in traders' warehouses, go to institutional buyers, or replace appliances already in use. It then listed what would actually have to be tracked — household consumption, the number of induction-using households, domestic gas demand, retail sell-through, the urban and rural split — none of which anybody is publishing.[1]

And the base effect is serious. Take the same two months of a year two earlier: **52,277** electric stoves imported. The same two months this year: **60,737**. That is **plus sixteen per cent over two years**, not a tripling. The spectacular year-on-year figure is measured against an unusually depressed intervening year of 25,230. Both series come from the same outlet, whose own eight-month components do not quite sum to its own stated total, and the two series may not use identical tariff codes.[1]

The gas trade says there is no shortage at all. **Diwan Bahadur Chand**, president of the LP Gas Industry Association, says industry data show no real shortfall and blames household panic-buying; the industry minister told parliament the same; the corporation's managing director says Indian supply is regular, and by August had imported **60,000 tonnes against 46,000 of demand**. On that account the whole transition is a distribution failure that will reverse. The utility, for its part, does not think the demand exists: its spokesman **Rajan Dhakal** has said it has "not seen much demand in our system yet" and that "the country needs big industries to consume our surplus energy".[2]

> *"It is not that we lack electricity. The infrastructure is old."*

The sharpest sceptic, though, is the government's own arithmetic. **Narayan Prasad Adhikari**, deputy executive director of the Alternative Energy Promotion Centre, told a National Assembly committee in September that if every Nepali household cooked by induction for two hours a day, demand would rise by **3,000 megawatts**. Read the utility's live dashboard on 26 October and national peak demand was **2,320 megawatts**; system capacity is about 4,300, or just under 4,000 excluding the flood-damaged plants. **The cooking estimate exceeds the entire country's current peak demand.** If the trend is real it is unserveable; if it is serveable it is not yet real.[3]



The state's own cooking estimate is larger than everything the country draws at its evening peak. *Meridian* original, from the utility's live dashboard and the agency's evidence to the National Assembly.[3]

There is also the question of who is actually buying. The retail price has moved with the demand — stoves at **2,500 to 2,800 rupees**, up fifteen to twenty per cent — and one importer now ships **up to 6,000 units in a container** where it previously sent about five hundred mixed in with other cargo. The state has quietly helped: the **one per cent customs duty on electric stoves was cut to zero** in the current budget, leaving only value-added tax, which for households drawing under fifty units a month is **five per cent rather than thirteen**. The budget target is **250,000 households** this year, though other official figures put it at half a million, and the two have never been reconciled.[2]

Which points at the real bottleneck, and it is not a dam. It is the **six-ampere fuse** in a great many Nepali homes, where induction wants fifteen or sixteen; the distribution transformer; and the **162 tripping incidents in a single year** that put one district of the Kathmandu Valley second nationally. A four-star hotel in the capital loses power up to four times a day for about ninety minutes and burns some five hundred litres of diesel a month to cover it. More than half of industrial facilities run generators.[4]

SOURCES 1 Nagarik News, 11 Ashwin 2083, read in full — the caveats and the list of untracked indicators are the outlet's own, and the longer series is its reporting. The two-year comparison is this magazine's own arithmetic from its figures, and the internal discrepancy in its eight-month components is noted here because the outlet does not explain it. 2 The trade association, the minister and the corporation as quoted in Nepali press reporting of August and September; the utility spokesman from the same. 3 Adhikari's estimate as reported in a Kathmandu Post column of 17 October; the dashboard figures read at the utility's own site on 26 October — peak demand 2,320 megawatts, zero imports and 21,517 megawatt-hours exported in the period shown. 4 The fuse rating from a Nepali explainer of 19 March; the tripping count, the hotel's diesel bill and the industrial-generator share from a confederation survey and local reporting, read at source.

The precedent is eleven years old and it ran the other way. From September 2015 India closed the border for five months after Nepal promulgated its constitution. Cylinders reached **8,000 rupees**. Households fell back on **firewood**, in an earthquake year. China donated **10,000 induction hobs**, which the state trading company sold at 4,000 rupees each, and the gesture went nowhere — because in 2015 Nepal had load-shedding of up to sixteen hours a day. An induction hob was a paperweight.[1]

The identical shock — supply cut off at the Indian frontier — now produces the opposite substitution, and only one variable changed in between. **Kul Man Ghising ended load-shedding in 2016 and 2017.** The 2015 blockade produced deforestation; the 2026 shock produces electrification. Which is the cleanest demonstration available that the enabling asset was never generation capacity in the abstract but *reliable delivery* — and that the next binding constraint sits one notch further down the same chain.[1]

"The government has chosen the easy tasks of exporting electricity."

So the argument. Nepal's energy problem was never megawatts; it was amperes, and the country is about to discover that through its kitchens. For fifteen years policy has been a single supply-side story — end load-shedding, build to 4,300 megawatts, export a thousand in the monsoon, sign for ten thousand over a decade. The kitchen was outside that story by institutional accident: cooking belonged to the oil corporation, to the gas dealers, to rural stove programmes. Electricity was for lights, industry and export. Four shocks in eleven months demolished the division of labour, and none of them was a price.[2]

Four things follow, in roughly this order. **One:** evening load-shedding returns to the Kathmandu Valley within a dry season or two, and is correctly diagnosed as a distribution failure rather than a generation one — a country exporting power in the monsoon and unable to cook dinner in March. **Two:** a capital fight breaks into the open, between the **390 billion rupees** estimated to restore flood-wrecked generation and grid, and the unglamorous last mile of transformers, fifteen-amp service drops and meters that cooking load actually needs. Generation has a lobby and nine thousand megawatts of stalled proposals. Distribution has none.[3]

Three: exports become politically contestable, because the argument that selling power to India transfers it from Nepali kitchens is already audible in the national papers. Watch December, when India reviews whether the 654 megawatts continue. **Four:** the gas dealer network becomes a declining rentier bloc that fights — seventeen and a half million cylinders, a sixty-billion-rupee trade, and a parliamentary committee proposing to barcode every cylinder and cross-match it against the utility's household records. That is not inventory management. It is the state preparing to meter a retreat.[3]

"I am getting more anxious every day. I don't even have an electric stove."

And the larger claim, which is why a Singapore reader should care about a Himalayan customs series. Nepal is the first country in the region where grid electricity is genuinely cheaper per useful megajoule than subsidised gas, because its power is domestic hydro and its gas is imported and loss-making. India, Bangladesh and Pakistan have that ratio the other way. So Nepal is the region's control experiment, running live, at household scale, with the customs office publishing results every month — and the finding it is generating is that end-use electrification cannot be scaled faster than the network that carries it. **The equity veto is the one the data cannot see.** Fifty-one per cent of households still burn wood, and a 2,500-rupee plate plus a fifteen-amp upgrade is a middle-class purchase; what the customs series shows may be the top two urban deciles switching twice. **Manisha Bhurtel**, a month into looking for a cylinder, is the sentence to end on.[4]

SOURCES 1 The 2015–16 blockade, the cylinder price, the donated hobs and the load-shedding hours from contemporary records read at source. 2 The export framing from the 2024 bilateral agreement and the July 2026 joint committee; the institutional account is this magazine's reading. 3 The restoration estimate and the stalled-proposal figure from Nepali reporting; the barcode proposal from a parliamentary committee chair. **The four predictions are this desk's and are flagged as forecasts.** 4 The regional comparison is this desk's argument; the equivalence crossover is sourced on p21, and Bhurtel is quoted there. **Reddit is unreachable, so there is no platform sentiment in this essay; every community voice is a named person in the Nepali press. A Nepali consumer explainer returned 403 and a university manuscript 503.**

THE LAST WORD

Counted, not settled

At twenty-one minutes to ten on Monday night, the president of Serbia's electoral commission read out a count and congratulated the winners from the chair — "in my name and in the commission's name, since I still represent the commission". Material from eight of ninety-three overseas polling places had reached him. The other eighty-five were ballots in transit (p4). Nothing he said was false. The count was simply not finished, and he said the part that was.

That is the shape this issue kept finding. In Brasília every section is counted and the loser is petitioning to annul two hours that his own campaign requested (p3). A company states first-half revenue as sixteen point three billion dollars and its total compute obligation as a dollar sign with the figure left out (p7). A laboratory prints "one hundred per cent recovery" and, pressed, concedes it is three benchmarks run once, two of them already at the ceiling (p8). A ten-year yield of exactly five per cent sits against a breakeven that will not move past 2.34 while inflation runs at 3.7, and tomorrow the committee meets (p14).

None of these is a lie either. Each is a real figure standing in for a question still open, and in almost every case the party that chose the moment of publication is the party with something to lose by waiting. The exception, and it is the one to keep, is a Nepali newspaper that broke a story about customs data and then printed, in its own pages, the reasons its own numbers could not yet mean what everyone would take them to mean (p22). Cromwell wrote the sentence on page two three weeks before Dunbar, to men who were quite sure. Think it possible you may be mistaken.

TWELVE DESKS · ONE WORLD

MERIDIAN · No. 145 · 27 October 2026

SOURCES A note on method. This edition's load-bearing figures were read where they are published: a registration statement on the Securities and Exchange Commission's own archive, in full; a proposed rule in the Federal Register's own text, compared line by line against the regulation it would replace; a Chinese ministry's attachment that is a proprietary binary behind a 403, retrieved and converted here; a Treasury yield curve and its real counterpart, subtracted on this desk; a Bureau of Labor Statistics release; six papers through the National Library of Medicine and Europe's open record; two makers' gauge charts and a third's refusal to publish one; a sanctioning body's rulebook; a physicist's own experimental write-ups; Nepal's customs figures as two newspapers report them and a utility's live dashboard; and promoter, venue or organiser pages for every dated event on p19. **Seven figures in this issue are this magazine's own arithmetic and all seven say so.** Where a host refused us — **Reddit for the twelfth issue running, and so there is no Reddit sentiment anywhere in this book; Reuters, the Associated Press, the BBC, the Financial Times and Bloomberg; Brazil's electoral court and Serbia's electoral commission, whose results portals render nothing to anything but a browser; Singapore's energy regulator, its ticketing site and its governing party; Audio-Technica, twice; Wikimedia, again; Smoking Meat Forums, the BBQ Brethren, Texas Monthly and AmazingRibs; the CME's FedWatch for a third issue running; and Instagram on all four restaurants** — the page says so rather than quietly substituting. **Every photograph in this issue was opened and looked at before it was captioned.**